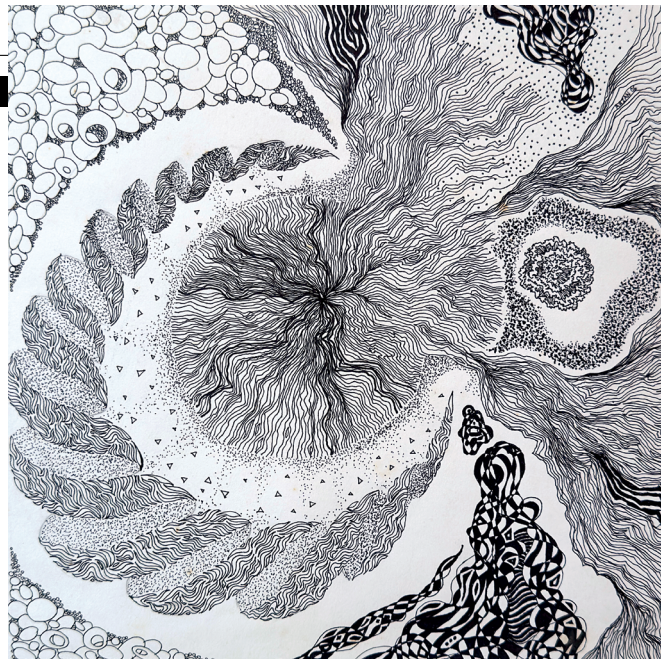
ART

# Mapping the Mind

Sculptor **Arzan Khambatta's** first pen-and-ink drawings show is a reflection of his subconscious feelings



Arzan Khambatta has what he calls "fidgety hands". For as long as he can remember, the renowned sculptor has doodled on notebooks and textbooks, right from his school days to even while attending phone calls. In 2011, when his mother fell ill and was in hospital, Khambatta would spend hours sketching pen-and-ink drawings as he and his siblings took turns to stay with her. All these years later, approximately 80 of his drawings are on display at Gallery Art & Soul in Mumbai as part of Khambatta's first such exhibition titled *Suspended Animation*.

Tightly composed, yet expansive, the lines on paper emerge from somewhere deep within, almost "like auto-writing", feels Khambatta. "Till the pen touches the paper, I am blank about how I am going to start. That's what makes the journey interesting for me. I just

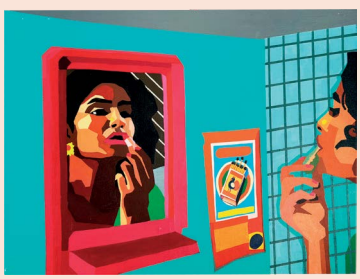
**DARK AND LIGHT** Clockwise from top, 'Eye in the Sky'; Khambatta in his studio; 'Metamorphosis'





# INFLECTION OF IDENTITIES

***An exhibition by the Aravani Art Project shines a light on the trials and triumphs of India's trans community***



**BURST OF COLOUR** Clockwise from top, 'Prathi Bimba Mirror Episode 1'; 'Yellama during Margasira' by Nandini and Raji; 'Clap Part 2 Prarthana' by Jyothi and Hamsa Sriram

India's transgender community has had a different trajectory from trans people across the globe. While the latter struggled to assert identity and find community, in India, the challenge has been to break the negative shackles of their identity and celebrate the community in a new light. The Aravani Art Project, a trans and cis women art collective started by Bengaluru-based Poornima Sukumar in 2016, has sown the seeds for this and blossomed into a meaningful movement over the last nine years.

Their first solo show titled